

05 / RESIDENCE TOUR CHECKLIST

Look beyond the lobby.

Take a copy on each visit. Include your parent's priorities. Arrange visits in line with the home's visitor and infection-control policies.

Before you go

- ☐ Ask for base rates, care packages and extra charges in writing.
- ☐ Confirm which needs the residence can and cannot support.
- ☐ Check the Ontario RHRA public register and inspection information.
- ☐ Ask to see a normal meal or activity, where available.
- ☐ Write down the three things that matter most to your parent.

During the visit

- ☐ How do staff speak to residents and answer your parent directly?
- ☐ Are people offered choices, privacy and help when they ask?
- ☐ Look at everyday shared spaces, access routes and bathrooms.
- ☐ Ask about current activities and how a person can participate.
- ☐ Observe meals, pace, assistance and dietary choices.

What did your parent notice? What needs a second visit?

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Ask about life as needs change.

The written agreement, service capacity and fit matter more than a tour score.

What is included, what costs extra, and how have rates changed?

Who is on site overnight, and what care can they provide?

What happens if needs exceed the residence’s services?

Trial stays, waitlist deposits, refunds and notice periods?

How are complaints and resident concerns handled?

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Compare the whole picture.

Add the care your parent needs to the housing price. Obtain current written estimates.

Compare	Residence A	Residence B	Residence C
Name / visit date			
Base monthly cost			
Care and other extras			
Estimated total / tax			
Needs they cannot meet			
Parent's priorities met?			
Agreement questions			
Next visit / follow-up			

Parent's preferred option and reasons / what remains unresolved